



PROGRESS REPORT

Africa: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-25-3 · 105 systems and instruments tracked

Compiled 2026-08-25 by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository. Sections run from the region's institutions outwards to what funds them. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.

SUMMARY OF THE PERIOD · INSTITUTIONS AND MANDATES · INSTRUMENTS AND HARMONISATION ·
SHARED SYSTEMS AND INFRASTRUCTURE · COORDINATION AND COLLABORATION · CAPACITY AND INCLUSION · FINANCE
· WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

Of 105 bodies, instruments and systems on this place's ledger, 50 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-25, 10 did not, 42 carry no stated baseline, and 3 are **Not held** at both ends.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 631 sources for this place in the window – 72 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-01), 559 in the later (2026-02 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

Movement values. *Advanced* – a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* – a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* – an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* – the programme ended. *No change* – the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* – the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

Summary of the period

The continental layer signed more than it built. The Commission [signed a cooperation agreement with the ITU](#) in July 2026 and [an AI memorandum with Google](#) in February.

Two payment developments were substantive. The Bank of Central African States [acceded to PAPSS on 2026-07-11](#), extending the rail into a third region; and the continent's central banks [ruled that a Payment Systems Directive is not to be led from outside them](#). At the window's close a third rail entered the record from the private side: a pan-African payments operator [argues that stablecoins are moving from speculation into the plumbing of remittances and business settlement](#), citing Mastercard's agreement to acquire BVNK at up to US\$1.8bn and Visa's stablecoin-card expansion through Stripe's Bridge into more than 100 countries. It is an operator's account of its own market, and no African regulator's treatment of stablecoin settlement is held against it.

The instruments the layer rests on did not move. A majority of the Union's 55 members [remain outside the Malabo Convention](#); no implementation report against the Continental AI Strategy of July 2024 is held; and the fund announced at Kigali in April 2025 [is still cited at US\\$60bn with nothing capitalised](#).

Institutions and mandates

Regional collaboration

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
AfCFTA Protocol on Digital Trade	State parties committed to expedite ratification and domestication under eight calls to action; no ratification count is published with them; the calls carry no enforcement mechanism, no ratification deadline and no named financing	Eight annexes to the protocol were approved in February 2025 and the intellectual-property annexes adopted in February 2026, and all of them still await national ratification and incorporation; the July 2026 calls to action to expedite ratification carry no enforcement mechanism, no deadline and no named financing, and no ratification count is published	ADVANCED, UNRATIFIED
AfCFTA Secretariat	Council bureau chaired by Egypt; the digital trade protocol adopted but no forum convened on it	Nigeria in the chair with digital trade among four stated priorities, a second digital trade forum held and a data-exchange system of the Secretariat's own launched	ADVANCED
Africa Internet Governance Forum	Baseline not held	The fifteenth annual forum is scheduled for the Labadi Beach Hotel, Accra, from 2 to 5 November 2026, running a main forum alongside youth, parliamentarian and Day Zero tracks and the African School on Internet Governance; session times, venues and speakers were not published when the schedule was read	ADVANCED
African Telecommunications Union (ATU)	Under the mandate set at the sixth session in Algiers in 2022, chaired by Algeria	A secretary general elected for the next four-year term, a 25-state administrative council seated, the chairmanship passed to Nigeria and a ministerial declaration adopted; the union's plenipotentiary conference ratified the return of its headquarters to Kinshasa on 23 July 2026, after the host state paid more than US\$1.4m in arrears, with no date stated for the move	ADVANCED
African Union Commission	Author of the Continental AI Strategy and the Digital Transformation Strategy, with no continental digital partnership agreement on record in the year before	Two cooperation instruments signed inside six months, with a US technology company and with the ITU, and a coordinated African position taken to the first global AI-governance dialogue	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
AFRICAN governance and receivership	Under an appeal-court order of 15 October 2024 directing the Official Receiver to complete the board election within two months, in substitution for the six months ordered in September 2023; no reconstituted board at the window's start, six months past that deadline	The regional internet registry named a person to all eight board seats on 12 September 2025 while withholding every candidate vote tally its own election guidelines promised; the purported board and the undischarged receiver announced close collaboration from 13 October 2025 without publishing which office could sign, pay or veto, and no court order, delegation, bank mandate or responsibility matrix has been located behind it; the receiver appointed an audit firm on 13 October 2025 to audit three overdue financial years without an annual meeting, with no published appointment date, executed instrument, statutory route, remuneration decision or independence review; ordinary resolutions on US\$3.29m of disputed legal spending, put to the June 2026 annual meeting, were still unresolved on the public record 46 days later; six regional members were named to a bylaws review committee without disclosing which constituents each represents; a member's challenge to the board's ratification of a policy draft remains open with an interim application declined and no reasoned merits decision; the appeal court set aside the registry's 2023 appeal for want of corporate authority without ruling on the receiver's permission or on statutory leave; and a governance committee of three elected and two board-appointed voting members was constituted on 17 August 2026 on terms running to the ends of 2027, 2028 and 2029	ADVANCED, AUTHORITY CHAIN UNRESOLVED
Algiers Declaration on African Telecommunications Sovereignty and Integrated Connectivity 2026-2030	Did not exist	Adopted as a continental position on integrated terrestrial, submarine and satellite infrastructure, local data centres, exchange points and cybersecurity; no work programme or text held	ADVANCED
Digital Parliaments Project Africa	Did not exist	Launch cohort of the parliaments of Ghana, Botswana and South Africa, the National Assemblies of the Gambia and Senegal, and the Pan-African Parliament, led by the POPVOX-DPP Foundation with the House Democracy Partnership; no amount, duration, funder or work programme stated	ADVANCED
Smart Africa Alliance	37 member states, working to the previous strategy	42 member states and a three-year strategy whose flagships are a data exchange, an innovation platform and digital identity; the secretariat issued two calls for expressions of interest on 13 August, one for content-delivery providers across broadband, data governance and cybersecurity and green-digital domains, and one for a consultancy to draft a gender-inclusion strategy for women's participation in ICT policymaking and governance, both closing on 31 August	ADVANCED
State parties to the AfCFTA	Baseline not held	49 of 54 signatories had deposited instruments of ratification as at July 2026, and Somalia is to become the 50th state party on depositing its instrument in September 2026, having agreed with the Secretariat a sequence running from ratification through domesticating the electronic tariff book and configuring preferential tariffs in its customs administration to a first shipment (2026-08)	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
African Financial Stability Committee	BASELINE NOT HELD	Hosted by the Association of African Central Banks and running a Macroprudential Policy Development and Implementation Working Group and an African Financial Stability Report Working Group; the continental portal carrying its mandate, structure, member central banks, meeting calendar and working groups was built and launched by the Central Bank of Egypt rather than by the association's secretariat, executing a decision of the 47th Assembly of Governors of 2025-11-28	<i>Baseline not held</i>
African Financial Stability Report	BASELINE NOT HELD	Inaugural 2024-2025 edition endorsed for publication by the Association of African Central Banks' 47th Assembly of Governors at Yaounde on 2025-11-28 and released in July 2026, covering 46 countries on data as at December 2024 with analysis through 2025. Its payments chapter, built from 26 central banks' published data, records that about 67 per cent of the continent's payment infrastructures are national systems run by central banks and 56 per cent of established systems handle retail, and finds the landscape fragmented, interoperability still limited and the operationalisation of regional and pan-African systems facing continuing challenges	<i>Baseline not held</i>
ATU Strategic Plan 2027-2031	BASELINE NOT HELD	A draft Strategic Plan for 2027-2031 was circulated to member states for comment ahead of CPL-26; the draft is not published, and no adopted plan, budget or final acts of the conference are held	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Korea-Africa Economic Cooperation ministerial framework	Baseline not held	Eighth ministerial set for Seoul under the theme of artificial intelligence and digital infrastructure, convened by the continental development bank with new co-financing expected	BASELINE NOT HELD

The Commission's year was one of external agreements. It [signed a memorandum with Google](#) at Addis Ababa on 2026-02-17 on AI and cloud infrastructure, skills and policy, and [a cooperation agreement with the ITU](#) at Geneva in July across AI, digital public infrastructure, connectivity and cybersecurity, which names the Commission the continental coordinating partner for its 55 member states. Alice Munyua reads the Google instrument as exposing African data to US jurisdiction under the CLOUD Act, [against a 2025 programme budget 77.5 per cent externally funded](#).

The African Telecommunications Union completed a leadership cycle at its [seventh Conference of Plenipotentiaries, Abuja, 23-24 July 2026](#): Kezias Kazuba Mwale of Zambia elected secretary general, a 25-state administrative council seated and the chairmanship passed from Algeria to Nigeria.

Smart Africa [grew from 37 to 42 member states](#) at Conakry in November 2025. Its board [established an Africa AI Council](#) on 2025-11-17 under 42 heads of state, with the AU Commissioner for Energy and Infrastructure and the ITU Secretary-General on it; no work programme or output of it is held.

The Association of African Central Banks took the period's most specific decision. Its [47th Assembly of Governors at Yaounde](#) issued 54 decisions, of which decision 21 states that the Payment Systems Directive for Africa should not be led by an entity external to central banks and directs the Assembly's own task force to lead it.

Instruments and harmonisation

Strategies, plans and policies

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Anti-IFFs Policy Tracker	Piloted eighteen months in Cote d'Ivoire, Ghana, Liberia, Namibia, Uganda and Zambia, built by Tax Justice Network Africa with the AU Commission's ETTIM department and the African Tax Administration Forum	Endorsed for continental roll-out as a standing self-assessment instrument scoring anti-IFF policy, legal, institutional and data-sharing frameworks; no roll-out timetable, country list or governance body named	ADVANCED
AUDA-NEPAD island economies programme	Did not exist	A country-owned framework for seven island states built around industrialisation, digitalisation, corridors and AI, in partnership with the Republic of Korea; the ministerial communique adopting it is not published	ADVANCED
Africa Technology Policy Tracker	BASELINE NOT HELD	A continental register built by the Carnegie Endowment with the African Telecommunications Union, consolidating national digital-economy laws, policies and regulations across infrastructure, platforms, skills and innovation; it indexes adopted documents only, weights nothing and assesses neither implementation nor rights compatibility. The counts reported on 2026-07-30 are 60 documents for Nigeria, 59 for Rwanda and 19 for Zambia	Baseline not held

Data protection

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Signatures and ratifications of the Malabo Convention	21 of 55 signed, 20 ratified or acceded and 20 deposited (2026-02-02, the depositary's register)	Equatorial Guinea, where the Convention was adopted and after whose then-capital it is named, signed on 2026-07-28 and has not deposited an instrument of ratification	ADVANCED, MARGINAL
Malabo Convention	In force, and the continental benchmark against which national data-protection regimes are measured	Unchanged in text; a majority of the Union's 55 members remain outside it twelve years after adoption	NO CHANGE
African Union Data Policy Framework	Baseline not held	In force as the continental reference framework, with about a third of the 54 member states aligned to it on a 2026-08-11 analysis, and 25 national regulatory sandboxes recorded across 15 countries by late 2024; no compliance mechanism, reporting cycle or enforcement route is stated	BASELINE NOT HELD

Standards

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
African Common Proposals for WRC-27	Preliminary African Common Proposals for WRC-27 and RA-27 are to be consolidated from the recommendations of the African Telecommunications Union's WRC-27 working groups at the third African Preparatory Meeting, Tunis, 7-11 September 2026, co-organised with Tunisia's Agence Nationale des Frequences; no proposal text is published	The union's third radiocommunication working group met as an e-meeting convened from Nairobi from 18 to 21 August 2026, input contributions having closed on 11 August, to prepare its recommendations for the third African Preparatory Meeting; the meeting's own output is not published, and no proposal text is published	ADVANCED
AFRINIC Constitution (Bylaws)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Fifth version in force since December 2020; the Bylaws Review Committee ran a first consultation from 2026-04-20, extended on 2026-05-08 to close 2026-05-17, and published a draft amended Constitution on 2026-08-04 for a second consultation closing 2026-08-21. It names membership, powers of members, the Nomination Committee and appointment of directors as the most heavily revised provisions, and a new Article 3 would write into the constitution that AFRINIC is the Regional Internet Registry for Africa and the Indian Ocean and that its governance will be periodically reviewed against internationally recognised governance standards. The published-draft milestone slipped about six weeks against the Committee's own indicative timetable while the Special General Members Meeting stayed in September 2026, and no consolidation or analysis of the first round's submissions is published; a second draft was open for comment from 4 to 21 August 2026. Proposed article 9.8 would let a two-thirds board vote revoke the nomination committee and restart an election the board itself had judged to have failed, with the same board defining the failure, deciding the case and triggering the consequence before any independent review; the current rule barring a conflicted director from voting would be dropped and recusal relocated into board policy, which matters because Mauritius company law lets an interested director vote after disclosure unless the constitution says otherwise; article 16 opens a wide advice channel with no register of advice given or received; and article 17.5 would create an acting chief executive office with no maximum term and no stated link to board seat 9 or to removal rules. A cyberdiplomacy consultant who had opposed early constitutional reform argued on 19 August that the article-by-article rationale now gives members enough to test the draft against the failures it is meant to fix	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Continental ICT standardisation alignment	BASELINE NOT HELD	Talks opened on a coordinated continental approach across the standards lifecycle, from development through harmonised adoption and implementation by countries, naming fragmentation and the failure to translate continental and international standards into national frameworks as the problem	<i>Baseline not held</i>

AI

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Africa AI Council	Did not exist	Established under a board of 42 heads of state with the AU Commissioner for Energy and Infrastructure and the ITU Secretary-General; no work programme or output held in the nine months since	ADVANCED
Africa AI Fund	Announced in April 2025 at US\$60bn, alongside the Africa AI Declaration, with nothing capitalised	Still cited as one pillar of the continental AI architecture; no capitalisation, governance structure or disbursement held	NO CHANGE
AU Continental AI Strategy	Adopted 2024-07-19 as the continental reference for national AI policy, on an implementation timeframe running 2025 to 2030	Unchanged in text, and the reference the Commission carried into global forums; ministers meeting at the ECA called for its translation into national frameworks. The instrument's own timetable runs Phase I across 2025-2026, a midterm review in 2027 and Phase II from 2028	NO CHANGE
Monitoring and evaluation of the AU Continental AI Strategy	Provided for in the Strategy through an African AI readiness index, a public monitoring dashboard and regional AI observatories, with nothing published	Still nothing published; the Peace and Security Council requested the Commission and its AI Advisory Group to submit periodic reports on 2026-04-16, and the Strategy's own midterm review falls in 2027	NO CHANGE
Common African Position on AI and its Impact on Peace, Security, Democracy and Development	BASELINE NOT HELD	The Council requested the Commission to expedite the comprehensive study and the Common African Position and submit them for its consideration; a Policy Brief on AI for Peace, Security and Governance in Africa is reported in progress and no text is published	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Google Africa Applied AI Lab	Did not exist	A co-development programme based at the Accra AI Community Centre and run with the sponsor's AI futures fund, giving selected African startups from pre-seed to Series C+ pre-release access to its Gemini, Gemma and Veo models plus research mentorship and go-to-market support, with no equity taken and no cash award guaranteed; it closes with a demo day in Accra	BASELINE NOT HELD

The binding continental instrument did not change. The Malabo Convention has been in force since 2023-06-08, and on [the depositary's register of 2026-02-02](#), 20 of 55 states had deposited an instrument of ratification. The one movement is that Equatorial Guinea, where the Convention was adopted and after whose then-capital it is named, [signed on 2026-07-28](#) and has still not deposited.

The Continental AI Strategy of July 2024 is likewise unchanged. Ministers at the Economic Commission for Africa [called for its translation into national frameworks](#) with dedicated data-governance funding; no implementation report against it is held.

What advanced were declarations. Ministers [adopted the Algiers Declaration](#) on telecommunications sovereignty for 2026-2030 in March, and the ATU ministerial meeting [adopted the Abuja Declaration on Meaningful Connectivity](#) on 2026-07-24, committing member states to technology-neutral regulation, fair access to spectrum and fibre, shared infrastructure and data governance. The text of neither is published, and the Abuja text was sought and not obtained.

Under the AfCFTA, state parties [adopted eight calls to action](#) at Lagos on 2026-07-07 to expedite ratification of the Protocol on Digital Trade. No ratification count is published with them, and an August account of implementation reports that [the protocol's eight annexes, approved in February 2025, and its intellectual-property annexes, adopted in February 2026, all still await national ratification and incorporation](#). Accession to the agreement itself runs well

ahead of accession to its digital provisions: the same account puts [49 of 54 signatories as having deposited instruments of ratification by July 2026](#), and the Secretariat closed a visit to Mogadishu in August having agreed that [Somalia will become the 50th state party on depositing in September 2026](#), on a sequence running from ratification through domesticating the electronic tariff book and configuring preferential tariffs in customs to a first shipment.

The Union's non-binding data instrument acquired a rough measure of its reach. An August analysis [puts about a third of the 54 member states aligned to the AU Data Policy Framework, and records 25 national regulatory sandboxes across 15 countries by late 2024](#). The alignment figure is that analyst's estimate rather than a Union count, and the framework carries no compliance mechanism, reporting cycle or enforcement route.

Shared systems and infrastructure

Connectivity

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
2026 Abuja Declaration on Meaningful Connectivity for Africa	Did not exist	Adopted, committing member states to technology-neutral regulation, continental harmonisation, fair access to spectrum and fibre, shared infrastructure and data governance; the text itself is not published	ADVANCED
Africa Digital Connectivity Infrastructure Report	BASELINE NOT HELD	Phase 1, Country Pilots, put out as an open consultancy tender at a stated budget of US\$165,000, funded jointly by the African Development Bank, the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank and the Multilateral Cooperation Center for Development Finance; the pilot countries and the terms of reference are not established	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Mobile internet users and their measured economic value	Baseline not held	416 million Africans used mobile internet in 2025, generating a measured US\$240bn of economic value, put at 7.8% of continental GDP	BASELINE NOT HELD

Data Storage

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Sovereign AI cloud on edge data centres	Did not exist	Announced: AI processing units hosted inside an African edge data-centre network, sold as locally-hosted enterprise AI	ADVANCED
Data centres the AfCFTA Secretariat states digital trade requires	BASELINE NOT HELD	More than 700, against about 220 on the continent, on the Secretary General's statement at Marrakech	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Time for a data centre to reach 85% occupancy	BASELINE NOT HELD	Six to eight years in African markets against two to three in Europe, on the Africa Data Centres Association's 2026 Economic Report, which also puts 80-90% of the continent's data as still processed and stored abroad and projects the market at US\$9.2bn by 2029	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Cybersecurity

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Privileged access management for the African Union Commission's own networks	Did not exist	A request for bids for the supply and installation of a privileged access management solution for the Commission's own networks (Ref. ET-AUC-560865-GO-RFB), amended on 21 August 2026 to push the bid deadline from 27 August to 10 September 2026 and to restate the licence requirement as 8 administrator, 40 enterprise privileged-user, 25 business-user and 5 external-vendor subscriptions on three-year terms, with training raised from six staff to eight	ADVANCED, SLIPPED
Reported cybercrime losses across the continent	About US\$192m reported (2024)	About US\$484m reported, more than double the 2024 figure, drawn from 36 member countries, with artificial intelligence involved in 55% of surveyed 2025 cybercrime cases and deepfake incidents up sevenfold between the second and fourth quarters of 2024; against that, only 8% of intelligence analysts are recorded as having advanced artificial-intelligence expertise and 94% of agencies as lacking digital forensics tools, and a single Ugandan deepfake investment scam is put at over US\$2m of losses	REGRESSED
Vendor-measured attack volume across the continent	None published	African organisations averaged 3,237 attacks a week in July 2026 against a global average of 2,336, behind Latin America at 3,561 and Asia-Pacific at 3,316; Angola was highest of the African markets broken out at 5,714, then Nigeria at 4,975, Kenya at 2,915 and South Africa at 2,195. Ransomware victims were up 87% year on year and the continent posted the world's highest phishing rate at 1 in 106 emails	ADVANCED
Standing in the global cybersecurity index	BASELINE NOT HELD	Mauritius, Rwanda, Kenya, Tanzania and Ghana in the top tier; Benin, Togo, Zambia and South Africa in the second; the majority of the continent below, scored across legal, technical and organisational measures, capacity building and international cooperation	Baseline not held

Data Exchange

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
ADAPT (Africa Digital Access and Public Infrastructure for Trade)	Did not exist	In pilot in Nigeria, Kenya and Morocco on the Secretary-General's statement to the second Digital Trade Forum; no live exchange, governing instrument or assessment held	ADVANCED
AU Digital Agriculture Strategy implementation	Adopted for 2024-2030 with an average agricultural growth target of 6 per cent and an estimated US\$165 million continental implementation cost, prioritising national e-agriculture strategies over a uniform regional approach after a 2021 situation analysis covering all 55 member states	A continental workshop convened regional economic communities, union organs and participating countries to harmonise implementation, seeking interoperable agricultural data platforms, common data governance and alignment of national and regional systems with the continental digital transformation strategy and agriculture reporting	ADVANCED
IGAD SDMX regional statistical-systems capacity-building programme	Did not exist	Outcome stated as harmonised SDMX Data Structure Definitions and a long-term roadmap institutionalising SDMX across IGAD and its member states under Open Data Portal 2.0; no budget, adoption date or roadmap milestone published	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
SADX (Smart Africa Data Exchange)	Did not exist	Unveiled at Conakry on 2025-11-12 and taken into a technical mission with Rwanda, Benin and Ghana on trust chains, interface contracts and incident response; no live exchange held; the alliance and a German development agency say a digital identity issued in one of Rwanda, Ghana or Benin is now recognised in the other two, with eighteen further countries said to be joining, presented as the first step to a single African digital market by 2030	ADVANCED
AU Data Policy Framework	In force since February 2022 as the continental reference for data governance, with none of its operative texts drafted	Unchanged in text; the three operative frameworks it provides for went to validation in December 2025 and none is adopted or published	NO CHANGE
AU Guidelines for Integrating Data Provisions in Protocols on Digital Trade	Issued September 2023 as a reference guide for negotiators integrating data provisions into the AfCFTA Protocol on Digital Trade	Unchanged; no record is held of its provisions being carried into the Protocol or its annexes	NO CHANGE
Smart Africa cross-border data exchange guidelines	Drafted by eleven member states under the Council of African IT Agencies	No adopted text, signatory list or implementation record held in the year since the drafting session	NO CHANGE
AfCFTA Customs Modernisation Project	BASELINE NOT HELD	A public-private partnership under which Bergmans Security Consultants and Supplies Limited mobilises the financing for customs digital solutions, secure electronic exchange of customs information, coordinated border management, One Stop Border Posts, transit systems, electronic cargo tracking, non-intrusive inspection technology, integrated data centres, multilingual customs portals, risk management and data analytics across participating State Parties; the agreement builds on a memorandum of understanding concluded in July 2026 and nothing is recorded as deployed; a US\$3.1bn contract was signed with a Nigerian security consultancy to digitise customs across the 50 member states, aiming at real-time cargo tracking and reduced revenue leakage	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Continental data governance frameworks	BASELINE NOT HELD	Three drafts - data categorisation and data sharing, cross-border data flows, and a continental open data strategy - validated with member states and regional economic communities; none submitted to AU policy organs and none published	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Digital Identity and CRVS

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
ADLI cohort on the AfCFTA Digital Identity Annex	Did not exist	Six countries across three trade corridors working on compliance with the annex, on a test-and-learn basis; no assessment or mutual-recognition decision held	ADVANCED
Adults holding official identification in Sub-Saharan Africa	None published on this basis	81% of adults, 82% of men against 79% of women, a 3.56-point gender gap (2025)	BASELINE NOT HELD

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
APAI-CRVS (Africa Programme on Accelerated Improvement of Civil Registration and Vital Statistics)	BASELINE NOT HELD	The 2017-2026 decade is closing and a 2027-2036 phase is opening; the African eCRVS Shared Asset (ACSA) is named as the shared continental standard intended to cut fragmented digital procurement across country systems, and Equatorial Guinea's Justice Ministry timed a free registration campaign for children aged 0-5 (10-14 August 2026) to the decade's close. No AU statement of the new phase's content, financing or targets is held	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Continental ID and data-protection law analyser	Baseline not held	An open-source tool launched by a university research network comparing identity and data-protection laws across more than 50 African countries, built as a retrieval-augmented chatbot and stated as intended to help states harmonise their frameworks; no usage figure, governance arrangement or maintenance commitment is published	BASELINE NOT HELD
Smart Africa digital identity blueprint	BASELINE NOT HELD	The alliance secretariat's first-edition blueprint for mutually recognised digital identity across member states, setting out the trust alliance, levels of assurance and the case for interoperable identity, drawn up after a member-state workshop	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Digital Payments and Fintech

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Association of African Central Banks (AACB)	No decision of the Assembly on continental payment harmonisation held	A list of 54 decisions, of which decision 21 rules that the Payment Systems Directive for Africa is not to be led by an entity external to central banks and directs its own task force to lead the work	ADVANCED
Banks and countries connected to PAPSS	28 banks within nine months of launch, against an ambition of all 500 to 600 African banks (2022)	28 countries and over 190 banks and financial-technology firms connected, with the Central African central bank acceding in July 2026 and the West African central bank's pilot pending; connecting the EAC, West, Central and Southern African regional systems is put at reaching more than 60% of African countries, and no continent-wide transaction value is published (2026-08)	ADVANCED
CARICOM Payment and Settlement System (CAPSS)	Did not exist; modelled on PAPSS since CARICOM governors' unanimous October 2023 selection	Proof of concept complete in two countries; the ECCB Governor says at least two more central banks are needed for the initial pilot; not commercially operational, with settlement, FX, liquidity, AML and interoperability arrangements unresolved	ADVANCED
Fintech volume carried by the continent's largest operator	None published on this basis	13.0 billion transactions carrying US\$330.5bn in the half, up 17.2% in volume and 33.8% in value in constant currency, on 70.8 million monthly active mobile-money users	ADVANCED
Pan-African Payment and Settlement System (PAPSS)	Operating from January 2022 across West and East African cores, with no Central African central bank participating	Extended into Central Africa by the BEAC's accession, wired into a national switch in Kenya for the first time, and carrying a wallet-based Nigeria-to-Ghana rail settled in naira	ADVANCED
PAPSSCARD	Did not exist	A continental card scheme launched to route African card payments inside the continent rather than through global networks; no issuance, volume or country coverage held	ADVANCED
UnionPay online acceptance through Standard Bank	A collaboration between the two parties dating from 2024, with no merchant count published	Online-payment acceptance for nearly 900 merchants across Botswana, Ghana, Kenya, Malawi, Namibia, Tanzania, Uganda, Zambia and Zimbabwe, settling in local currency, US dollars or both, against a stated African footprint of about 7 million UnionPay cards issued	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
African take-up of China's Cross-Border Interbank Payment System	Baseline not held	Reported as spreading across African banks as an alternative to Swift, smoothing trade settlement and potentially easing exposure to dollar sanctions, with Libyan banks set to join after talks between the Central Bank of Libya and the People's Bank of China. No participant list, transaction volume or value is held	BASELINE NOT HELD
COMESA digital retail payments platform	BASELINE NOT HELD	The regional clearing house published the scheme rulebook setting operational and governance rules for instant low-cost cross-border retail payments, and a gender audit and strategy to 2030 drawn from research along the Malawi-Zambia corridor	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Cost of sending money within Africa	Baseline not held	Put at 8.78% of the amount sent against the SDG target of 3% (2026-08)	BASELINE NOT HELD
Payment Systems Directive for Africa (PSDA)	BASELINE NOT HELD	Directed to be led by central banks rather than an external entity, with the Assembly's own task force on payment system integration to lead harmonisation; no draft directive held	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Stablecoin settlement rails serving African cross-border payments	Not held	Described by a pan-African payments operator's product chief as moving from speculative use into the plumbing of remittances and business settlement, on the evidence of Mastercard's agreement to acquire BVNK at up to US\$1.8bn and Visa's stablecoin-card expansion through Stripe's Bridge into more than 100 countries, African markets among them; a first named African deployment is Flutterwave's tie-up with Caliza offering USD accounts with USDC and USDT conversion	BASELINE NOT HELD
Unmet trade finance demand	BASELINE NOT HELD	US\$74bn to US\$100bn of unmet trade finance demand, with commercial banks intermediating about 23% of the continent's trade against 40% over 2011 to 2019, and intra-African trade at US\$213.8bn in 2025 (2026-08)	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Sectoral management information systems

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Africa CDC Central Data Repository	Did not exist	A federated repository integrating national surveillance, laboratory and programme data in which member states retain ownership of their data	ADVANCED
African Regional Integration Synthesized Index (ASRII) platform	BASELINE NOT HELD	The African Union Commission's platform for submission, validation, automated computation and dissemination of regional integration scores across political, economic, infrastructure, and human and social pillars, developed with the regional economic communities, the Economic Commission for Africa and the African Development Bank to replace manual data collection. Deployment to the regional economic communities began with a four-day training of 20 core participants at the ECOWAS Commission in Abuja on 4-7 August 2026, at which its Secretary General said the Commission holds no centralised database of the status, amendments and implications of regional legal protocols	<i>Baseline not held</i>

PAPSS moved most. The Bank of Central African States [acceded on 2026-07-11](#), extending a rail whose cores were West and East Africa into a third region; Kenya's Pesalink [joined as a connectivity provider](#), the first national switch wired in for transaction termination; and a wallet-based Nigeria-to-Ghana rail [settling fully in naira](#) opened with the central bank's approval. PAPSS is cited at more than 160 banks and 400 million accounts across 19 countries. What

the rail does not fix is the currency layer beneath it: AfricaNenda's deputy chief executive puts more than 40 African currencies, many not directly convertible, as the constraint that payment rails alone cannot lift, with connected regional systems able to reach more than 60% of African countries only if regulators harmonise licensing and settlement, and sets the cost of sending money within Africa at 8.78% against an SDG target of 3% — a figure given in interview, with no corridor set or methodology behind it. The commercial answer to the same problem arrived a fortnight earlier and routes around the continental rail entirely: a pan-African payments operator tied up with a US infrastructure provider to give African businesses dedicated dollar accounts on ACH, Fedwire, RTP and SWIFT with stablecoin conversion, aimed at transfers above US\$1m and stated as cutting reliance on correspondent banking.

Cross-border data exchange advanced twice over. Smart Africa took SADX into a technical mission at Kigali with Rwanda, Benin and Ghana in April 2026, on trust chains, interface contracts and incident response. The AfCFTA Secretariat's ADAPT, a system of the same purpose, was launched five days after SADX was announced in November 2025, on Data Landscapers' account. Neither has a live exchange on the record.

The one continental system that entered service is Africa CDC's Central Data Repository, launched on 2026-01-28, a federated store of national surveillance, laboratory and programme data in which member states retain ownership of their data. A second, smaller one arrived in August: a university research network launched an open-source analyser comparing identity and data-protection laws across more than 50 African countries, built as a retrieval-augmented chatbot and stated as intended to help states harmonise their frameworks. No usage figure, governance arrangement or maintenance commitment accompanies it. A third was announced rather than launched: an enterprise AI vendor and an edge data-centre operator said they would sell AI processing units hosted inside the operator's African sites as a sovereign AI and cloud offering, with financial institutions named as the first market. No site list, capacity, price or launch date is published, so the sovereignty claim rests on hosting location alone.

What those systems run against was measured twice this window by parties with an interest in the answer. Alongside the reported-loss figures collected from member countries, a security vendor put African organisations at 3,237 attacks a week in July against a global average of 2,336, with ransomware victims up 87% year on year and the continent's phishing rate the world's highest at 1 in 106 emails — Angola highest of the markets it broke out at 5,714, then Nigeria, Kenya and South Africa. It is one vendor's telemetry from its own installed base, on an undisclosed sample and denominator, and it is a different series from the loss figures, not a check on them.

The layer's own use figures were restated rather than measured afresh: an industry association's data, cited on 2026-08-12, puts 416 million Africans on mobile internet in 2025 generating US\$240bn of economic value, or 7.8% of continental GDP. The value is a modelled figure of the association's own, reaching the base through a secondary account.

Coordination and collaboration

ICT Industry

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Charging for business messages on a dominant messenger	Service messages on the business platform free of charge	Free service messages to end from 1 October 2026, with businesses charged for every delivered message at rates varying by country and by message type, a cost increase for African companies that rely heavily on the messenger for customer service	REGRESSED

Innovation ecosystem

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Multi-country mapping of innovation-support organisations	BASELINE NOT HELD	A EUR120,000 procurement opened by a European development agency for a multi-country mapping of African entrepreneurship- and innovation-support organisations under a Europe-Africa digital innovation programme	<i>Baseline not held</i>

US / hyperscaler activities

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
America First Global Health Strategy data-sharing agreements	Did not exist; no bilateral United States health agreement of this kind on record before December 2025	Memorandums worth US\$20bn signed with more than 30 countries since December 2025, on a model Data Sharing Agreement giving the United States at-will access to seven classes of national health system for 25 years with a 10-year post-termination tail; Ghana refused in April 2026, Zimbabwe withdrew in February 2026 and Zambia shelved in May 2026, and Kenya's framework is before the Court of Appeal with a final ruling due at the end of October 2026; the State Department's standard-form memorandum, held as a blank template dated 2026-03-11, commits a partner government to name and run its electronic medical record, laboratory, pharmacy, surveillance, commodity-inventory and national data warehouse systems, to load 90 per cent of clinical encounters into the electronic medical record within two years of rollout in a facility, to enter a data sharing agreement expected to run twenty-five years, and to provide specimens and genetic sequence data of pathogens with epidemic potential within five days of detection, with section 4.7 making failure on those commitments grounds for changing or discontinuing the assistance; the signed texts are withheld, the department having published a subset of the memorandums in March 2026 and then removed public access, and a freedom-of-information suit covering sixteen African countries (Public Citizen v. Department of State, No. 1:26-cv-01137, D.D.C.) was unresolved when filed on 2026-04-02; a rights organisation's clause-by-clause assessment of the seven signed memorandums it holds - Ethiopia, Kenya, Mozambique, Nigeria, Rwanda, Liberia and Uganda - reports that the model's terms were not applied uniformly: all seven require broad audit access, three (Liberia, Mozambique and Rwanda) commit to supplying any data requested for that audit with no privacy safeguard stated, two (Liberia and Nigeria) defer the data-sharing arrangement to an unpublished appendix, and the specimen and pathogen-sequencing clause appears in five of the seven, with Liberia and Kenya outside it Eight United States senators wrote to the Secretary of State in the week to 2026-08-19 challenging the demands for direct access to partner governments' own health-data systems as a condition of lifesaving aid, calling them unprecedented and at odds with United States policy on the data of American citizens, and requesting a briefing on the agreements' data requirements and a written answer by the end of August 2026.	ADVANCED, REFUSED BY THREE STATES AND CHALLENGED IN THE UNITED STATES SENATE
US-AUC Strategic Investment Working Group	Did not exist	Agreed to channel US private investment into AU-backed infrastructure including digital transformation, on an investment-in-place-of-aid posture; no membership, meeting or work programme held	ADVANCED

China activities

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
China-Africa Digital Cooperation Development Action Plan	Issued 2024-07-29 by China and 26 African states across six cooperation actions, with a three-year target of ten joint digital transformation demonstration projects and 1,000 personnel trained	Unchanged; no progress report, no accession beyond the original 26 states and no delivery against the three-year targets is held	NO CHANGE
Chinese artificial-intelligence cooperation centres with the African Union	BASELINE NOT HELD	China says it will establish artificial-intelligence application cooperation centres with the African Union and offer developing countries 5,000 training places over five years; no site, budget, term or agreement text is stated	Baseline not held

EU activities

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
AU-Germany strategic dialogue	No dated session held in the base	Reviewed the partnership and named AI governance and cybersecurity among the areas for cooperation, within a dialogue that is principally about peace and security	ADVANCED, MARGINAL

Coordination ran outward. The United States and the Commission [announced a Strategic Investment Working Group](#) on 2026-01-28 to channel US private investment into AU-backed infrastructure including digital transformation, in place of aid; no membership, meeting or work programme is held. Germany and the Commission [held a strategic dialogue](#) on 2026-07-15 naming AI governance and cybersecurity among its areas.

Two programmes started inside the window. AUDA-NEPAD [launched a programme for the seven island economies](#) at Abidjan on 2026-07-24, built around industrialisation, digitalisation, corridors and AI with the Republic of Korea; the communique adopting it is not published. The Africa Data Leadership Initiative [convened six countries across three corridors](#) with the AfCFTA Secretariat on the Digital Identity Annex.

The Korean channel widened at the same time. The continental development bank [called the eighth Korea-Africa ministerial for Seoul on 8-11 September 2026, on the theme of artificial intelligence and digital infrastructure](#), with new co-financing expected. That is an advisory rather than an outcome: what it produces is not yet on record, and no figure is stated in advance.

Capacity and inclusion

Digital divides

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Women and girls digital-inclusion accelerator	BASELINE NOT HELD	An industry-body accelerator backed by two private foundations opened its next call for digital-inclusion solutions for women and girls across India and sub-Saharan Africa, with a grant amount listed at INR 42,000,000	Baseline not held

Capacity work at continental level is bought rather than built, and this window shows it being bought. The alliance secretariat [called for content-delivery providers across broadband, data governance and cybersecurity and green-digital domains](#) and, the same day, [for a consultancy to draft a gender-inclusion strategy for women's participation in](#)

ICT policymaking and governance, both closing at the end of August. A European development agency opened a EUR120,000 procurement for a multi-country mapping of African entrepreneurship- and innovation-support organisations, and an industry body reopened an accelerator for digital-inclusion solutions for women and girls across India and sub-Saharan Africa. All four are calls rather than awards, so what the period establishes is intent and budget, not delivery: no supplier, cohort or output is on record for any of them.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Share of the African Union's budget financed by its own members	About 22 to 25 per cent, a decade after the 2016 Kigali Decision	Unchanged on the newest figure held; the Union's 2025 programme budget was 77.5 per cent externally funded	NO CHANGE

MoUs and other agreements

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
AUC-Google memorandum on AI	Did not exist	Signed on AI and cloud infrastructure, skills, research and AI policy, with a pledge to train three million students and teachers by 2030	ADVANCED
AUC-ITU cooperation memorandum	Did not exist	Signed across AI, digital public infrastructure, skills, connectivity, cybersecurity, space technology and standards, naming the Commission the continental coordinating partner for the 55 member states	ADVANCED
Five-year telecommunications and digital-infrastructure memorandum with an Indian technology company	Did not exist	A five-year memorandum of agreement between an Indian technology company, a continental investment council and an Ivorian mobile operator to develop telecommunications and digital public infrastructure across the continent, dated 2026-08-07 and fully executed on 2026-08-19 per a regulatory filing. It covers national fibre backbones, 4G and 5G, submarine cable landing stations, internet exchange points, telecom towers, and digital identity, national interoperability, e-government and digital payment platforms. No financial commitment is disclosed	BASELINE NOT HELD

New investments

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Digital Africa Seed Fund	Did not exist	A closed-end seed-stage fund with a ten-year horizon, sized at EUR 30m with a hard cap of EUR 50m, targeting 30 startups across 20 priority African countries at an average first ticket of EUR 300,000, and positioned as the seed step between the sponsor's pre-seed vehicle and institutional Series A investors	ADVANCED
Foundation call for AI in family planning	Did not exist	A private foundation opened a call for proposals using artificial intelligence to widen access to digital contraception information across sub-Saharan Africa, offering up to US\$500,000 a project, with applications closing on 25 August 2026	ADVANCED
Hewlett Foundation grant to BudgIT (general operating support)	Did not exist	US\$1,000,000 committed (US\$500,000 disbursed) as general operating support to BudgIT's budget-transparency and civic-tech work	ADVANCED

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Hewlett Foundation grant to BudgIT (learning systems and communications)	Did not exist	US\$50,000 committed and fully disbursed to strengthen BudgIT's learning systems and strategic communications	ADVANCED
Hewlett Foundation grant to Cenfri (digital transformation programme)	Did not exist	US\$300,000 committed (US\$150,000 disbursed) to renew Cenfri's work on digital transformation and its link to evidence-informed policymaking across Africa	ADVANCED
Hewlett Foundation grant to Data4Change (Data Hub: Africa)	Did not exist	US\$400,000 committed (US\$200,000 disbursed) to Data4Change's Africa Hub, building community-generated evidence for policy and practice in East and West Africa	ADVANCED
Hewlett Foundation grant to ICED (AI-enabled evidence generation)	Did not exist	US\$100,000 committed and fully disbursed for the International Centre for Evaluation and Development to adopt AI-enabled evidence generation institution-wide	ADVANCED
IFC equity investment in Jumia	Did not exist	US\$25m of IFC equity inside a wider US\$50m raise	ADVANCED
Mergers and acquisitions in the digital economy	68 deals across the whole of 2025	84 deals worth an estimated US\$11.4bn in disclosed value between 1 January and 17 August 2026	ADVANCED
Share of funded African tech startups led by a female chief executive	17 of 178 funded ventures, 9.6%, taking 7.9% of the capital (2025)	5 of 60, 8.3%, taking 2.8% of the capital (2026 to May)	REGRESSED
TaxDev III (IFS tax and social-protection policy data programme)	Did not exist	Institute for Fiscal Studies programme, funded by the UK's FCDO, building tax and social-protection policy data resources and tools with finance ministries and revenue authorities in Ethiopia, Ghana, Kenya, Nigeria, Rwanda and Uganda; about US\$6.36m disbursed 2023-2026	ADVANCED
EU Multiannual Indicative Programme for Sub-Saharan Africa 2021-2027	EUR 490m for priority area 4, Digital and Science, Technology and Innovation, of which EUR 240m for digital transformation, within a regional envelope of EUR 12,000m	Unchanged; the mid-term review cut priority area 4 from EUR 1,240m to EUR 490m and its digital transformation component from EUR 940m to EUR 240m, or 2.0 per cent of an envelope enlarged from EUR 10,242m to EUR 12,000m, and no later amendment is held	NO CHANGE
Africa Finance Corporation digital bond	Baseline not held	CHF 350m raised on a five-year digital bond listed, traded and settled on a regulated digital exchange — stated as the first by an African institution — priced at a 1.4925% coupon and arranged by two European banks; it is the issuer's fourth and largest Swiss franc issuance	BASELINE NOT HELD
Africa50 Infrastructure Acceleration Fund	BASELINE NOT HELD	Fourth close of about US\$330m, joined by British International Investment's US\$20m commitment alongside the African Development Bank, the International Finance Corporation and more than 20 African institutional investors; the fund, managed by Africa Infrastructure Investment Partners, directs capital to logistics, power, water and sanitation and social infrastructure as well as digital connectivity; the size and date of earlier closes are not established	Baseline not held
AI 10 Billion Initiative	Did not exist	Launched, with a ten-month partnership roadshow to follow	BASELINE NOT HELD
BIASHARA 2063 project (AU Commission institutional systems)	BASELINE NOT HELD	A World Bank-financed programme building the Commission's own institutions and systems, procuring wireless infrastructure for its headquarters; no envelope, timetable or results framework held	Baseline not held
Capital raised by startups from a technology company's African accelerators	Baseline not held	More than US\$1bn raised cumulatively since 2017, with a stated survival rate above 90% against a 70-80% failure rate for the wider ecosystem (2026-08)	BASELINE NOT HELD

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Development-finance and infrastructure-fund partnership	Baseline not held	A British development finance institution and a continental infrastructure fund announced a strengthened partnership to scale infrastructure financing across Africa, connectivity among the named sectors; no commitment amount, fund vehicle, country allocation or timetable is published	BASELINE NOT HELD
Growth-capital investment in a pan-African messaging infrastructure provider	Baseline not held	US\$12m into a provider of application-to-person messaging — one-time passwords, transaction alerts and delivery updates — operating across 35 African countries through 15 operator partnerships	BASELINE NOT HELD
KOICA Youth Leadership Programme	BASELINE NOT HELD	US\$34m stated by Korea for a programme coupling public governance and policy development with artificial-intelligence-driven digital government, hosted by the Ghana Institute of Management and Public Administration for 200 participants from Ghana, Nigeria, Cote d'Ivoire, Senegal and Cameroon, in three phases - online training, in-country sessions, and a funded 14-day study visit to Korea for the best performers	Baseline not held
Limited-partner commitments to African private-capital funds	Baseline not held	64 commitments in the second quarter of 2026 against 53 a year earlier, with disclosed value of US\$272m against US\$847m in the same quarter of 2025 and US\$1.18bn in the first quarter of 2026; no disclosed commitment above US\$50m, and information technology appeared in 61% of commitments against 17% a year earlier	BASELINE NOT HELD
LINGUA Africa language-model grants	Baseline not held	26 projects covering more than 50 African languages, dialects and sign languages across 47 countries, each awardee eligible for up to US\$250,000 in cash and US\$400,000 in compute credits; health, agriculture and justice are the stated use cases	BASELINE NOT HELD

The continental layer's financing did not move. The Africa AI Fund announced at Kigali in April 2025 [is still a US\\$60bn figure](#) with no capitalisation, governance or disbursement on the record.

Consolidation, not fundraising, is where the money went. A trade researcher [counted 84 mergers and acquisitions in Africa's digital economy worth an estimated US\\$11.4bn in disclosed value between 1 January and 17 August 2026, past the 68 recorded across the whole of 2025](#), led by financial services on 27 deals and by targets in South Africa, Nigeria and Egypt, with [a mobile group's proposed US\\$6.2bn purchase of 75 per cent of a tower company the largest single disclosed value](#). It is a research count rather than a regulatory or exchange series, disclosed value only, and it stands against [US\\$1.44bn raised by startups in the first half of the year on the same publisher's figures](#) — the exit route now larger than the entry one.

What raised money in August raised it on markets rather than from pledges. A continental infrastructure financier [issued a five-year digital bond of CHF 350m, listed, traded and settled on a regulated digital exchange and stated as the first by an African institution, at a 1.4925% coupon and arranged by two European banks](#). Alongside it, a British development finance institution and a continental infrastructure fund [announced a strengthened partnership to scale infrastructure financing, connectivity among the named sectors](#) — with no commitment amount, fund vehicle, country allocation or timetable, so no finance record was built for it.

Private money moved on narrower objects. A private-capital fund [put US\\$12m into a provider of application-to-person messaging operating across 35 African countries through 15 operator partnerships](#) — one-time passwords, transaction alerts and delivery updates, which is to say the rails a great deal of the continent's payment estate actually runs on. Philanthropic and corporate money went to language: [26 projects covering more than 50 African](#)

languages, dialects and sign languages across 47 countries were selected on 14 August, each awardee eligible for up to US\$250,000 in cash and US\$400,000 in compute credits, against health, agriculture and justice use cases. No single total is published for it, so the programme can only be bounded from its per-award ceiling.

The accelerator layer published a claim rather than a commitment: a technology company said startups from its African programmes had raised more than US\$1bn cumulatively since 2017, at a survival rate it puts above 90%. It is the company's own figure, with no cohort list, no definition of survival and no source for the failure rate it is set against.

The development financiers took equity rather than lending in one case: the World Bank Group's private-sector arm invested US\$25m of equity in a listed pan-African e-commerce platform operating in eight countries, inside a wider US\$50m raise. The stated development case — about 60,000 active sellers, around 1,800 direct jobs and income for more than 100,000 independent sales agents — is the investor's own projection, and carries no date on which it is to be tested.

One call opened at the end of the window: a private foundation offered up to US\$500,000 a project for artificial intelligence widening access to digital contraception information across sub-Saharan Africa, closing on 25 August. No envelope total, grant count or decision date accompanies it, so the ceiling is the only figure the call can be bounded by.

The Union's own finances bound what it can carry: members fund about 22 to 25 per cent of its budget a decade after the 2016 Kigali Decision, and its institutional systems are built with World Bank money — a tender of 2026-07-27 for wireless infrastructure at its headquarters runs under the BIAHARA 2063 project, whose envelope and results framework are not held. Against that, the AfCFTA Secretariat puts the requirement for digital trade at more than 700 data centres against about 220 on the continent, on its own estimate.

Where the record is thin

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Ratifications and domestication of the AfCFTA Protocol on Digital Trade	The AfCFTA Secretariat's or the depositary's ratification list, against the threshold the Protocol sets for entry into force; probed 2026-08-05: no depositary list located, but published legal analyses state the threshold is 22 state parties and that it has not been met, and name Nigeria as the first to approve ratification; located, not fetched	2026-08-05
Member-state implementation status of the AU Data Policy Framework	A Commission report on domestication by member state; probed 2026-08-05: no status report located, but the Commission held a validation workshop at Addis Ababa on 1-4 December 2025 on three draft continental frameworks — data categorisation and sharing, cross-border data flows, and an open data strategy — which the base does not hold at all; located, not fetched	2026-08-05
Budget of the African Union's own digital programme	A budget line for the Information Society division or the Digital Transformation Strategy, as against the Union's headline budget; probed 2026-08-05: the 2026 budget totals and the programme-budget split are published in secondary analyses, with no digital line disaggregated in anything located	2026-08-05

Five named objects carry no position at either end, and each was searched on 2026-08-05. All five searches returned published material the base does not hold; acquisition lines are raised and nothing is cited above.

Three bear on whether the instruments above are implemented. The Continental AI Strategy is published on the Union's own site with a 2025-2030 implementation period and a 2027 midterm review, and a Peace and Security Council communique of 2026-04-16 asks for periodic reports; none of that is held. Published legal analyses state that the Protocol on Digital Trade needs 22 state parties to enter into force and that the threshold has not been met.

On the Data Policy Framework, the search returned no status report but did return a Commission validation workshop at Addis Ababa on 1-4 December 2025 on three draft frameworks — data categorisation and sharing, cross-border data flows, and an open data strategy — which the base does not hold at all.

The other two are financial: nothing located disaggregates a digital line in the Union's budget, and the ATU's adopted plan and budget for its next period were not located. On this record the continental layer's instruments are visible and their implementation is not.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-08-25-3
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/XAF/XAF-progress.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/XAF/XAF-progress-2026-08-25-3.pdf
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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.